

L'OCCITANE GROUP

Managed Transportation Services — RFI Vendor Comparison Report

Generated: April 28, 2026 | Evaluating 5 vendors against 11 weighted criteria

1. Sourcing Brief

L'Occitane Group is evaluating Managed Transportation Services (MTS / 4PL) providers for its North American (US + Canada) logistics operations. Key requirements: (1) Proven MTS specialization with CPG/beauty/retail client experience; (2) ISO 9001 certification and strong ESG credentials (L'Occitane is sustainability-forward); (3) Full US + Canada coverage with global scalability; (4) Modern TMS with robust KPI reporting; (5) Flexible, non-mandatory carrier network; (6) Clear SLAs and escalation processes; (7) Financially stable and transparent.

Scoring Rubric (11 Weighted Criteria)

1	Strategic Fit (Industry)	15%	CPG/beauty/retail experience; seasonality, returns, fragile-goods handling
2	Service Specialization (MTS)	15%	% revenue from MTS; depth of MTS customer base
3	Quality & ESG Certifications	15%	ISO 9001, ISO 14001, ECOVADIS, SMETA — L'Occitane is sustainability-forward
4	Geographic Coverage	10%	NA + ability to scale globally
5	Financial Stability	10%	Profitability, revenue trend, transparency
6	Technology (TMS, KPIs)	10%	Modern TMS, breadth of KPIs, API readiness
7	Scale & Capacity	5%	Big enough to handle volume, small enough to care
8	Carrier Network Flexibility	5%	Multi-carrier, non-mandatory, leverages existing contracts
9	Operational Excellence	5%	Specific SLAs, clear escalation, proven peak handling
10	Risk Management & Continuity	5%	BCP depth, customs expertise, redundancy
11	RFI Response Quality	5%	Completeness, specificity vs. boilerplate, transparency

2. Ranking Summary

Vendors are ranked by weighted fit score (0–100). Hard-constraint failures are penalised heavily on the relevant criterion and noted as red flags. Vendors within 5 points of each other should be treated as a tie requiring further due diligence.

1	KN	87.2	Purpose-built 4PL with cosmetics-sector clients, ISO 9001/14001/22301/45001, Oracle OTM + Tableau, follow-the-sun SLA, and CHF 800M profitable parent.	• Financial detail for KN IL division not available (only parent-level figures) • Labor/overhead cost structure not disclosed (corporate policy) • Competitor information not shared (corporate policy) • TMS mandatory where deployed — limited flexibility to use client's existing systems
2	Ceva	63.9	Global scale with 78K employees and ISO 9001, but MTS is only 14% of revenue and two years of net losses temper confidence.	• Net losses of -\$242M (2018) and -\$166M (2019) — financial risk • MTS is only 13.6% of CEVA's revenue — not a core offering • Primary contact information left blank in RFI • No ISO 14001 or sustainability certifications noted (ESG gap)
3	Allyn	57.1	Highest MTS revenue concentration (80-90%), 30 clients, US Licensed Customs Brokers, but core industry mix (Oil & Gas/Electronics) differs from L'Occitane's beauty/CPG profile.	• ISO 9001 certification still in progress (not yet achieved) • Core industries are Oil & Gas, Electronics, Aerospace — limited CPG/beauty fit • Relatively small MTS client base (30 customers) • BCP response is minimal (references T&Cs; only)
4	Gefco	35.1	Fails two hard constraints: explicitly not an MTS specialist with 0 MTS customers and no US/Canada MTS operations.	• HARD CONSTRAINT FAIL: explicitly states it is NOT an MTS specialist (Q2.7: No) • HARD CONSTRAINT FAIL: 0 MTS customers; does not operate MTS in US or Canada • No ISO certifications (only C-TPAT) • Cannot perform freight audit • Thin US team (44 employees total)
5	Continental Logistics	29.5	Food/CPG MTS broker with strong carrier network, but 10-person team, zero certifications, and entirely blank financial section limit credibility.	• No financial data provided (turnover, P&L; all blank) • Team of only 10 employees — capacity concern for a major beauty brand • No quality certifications of any kind • No Canada operations; US-only coverage • No documented customers shared

* Scored pessimistically where data was ambiguous or missing. See Per-Vendor Notes for full original text.

3. Full Comparison Table

Vendors in ranked order (left to right). Questions follow template order. '—' denotes a blank or missing answer in the vendor's submission. Answers marked * were summarized (<=25 words); full text appears in Section 4.

1. COMPANY DATA					
1.1 Company	Kuehne + Nagel Integrated Logistics (KN IL)	CEVA Freight, LLC	Allyn International Services, Inc.	GEFCO Forwarding USA Inc.	Continental Logistics
1.2 Tax Code	Not applicable	76-0094895	FEIN 56-0313967	11-3292371	22-2455592
1.3 Founded	1890 (Kuehne + Nagel Group)	2007	1992	1992	1983
1.4 Company Type	4PL Managed Services Provider	Not specified	Producer (4PL)	Distributor	Trader
1.5 Affiliate/Group	Yes — Kuehne + Nagel International AG	Yes — CMA CGM Group	No	Yes — GEFCO Group	Yes — Port Jersey Logistics
1.6 HQ Location	Schindellegi, Switzerland (KN IL Americas: Raleigh, NC)	15350 Vickery Dr, Houston, TX 77032	Fort Myers, Florida, USA	1541 Elmhurst Rd, Elk Grove Village, IL 60007	Cranbury, New Jersey
1.7 Primary Contact	Craig Brodie, VP BD; 5410 Trinity Rd Suite 400, Raleigh, NC 27607	Not provided	13391 McGregor Blvd, Fort Myers, FL 33919	1541 Elmhurst Rd, Elk Grove Village, IL; +1 630-259-8892	Cranbury, NJ / Alfredo Fumacas
1.8 CEO	Dr. Detlef Trefzger	Mathieu Friedberg	Allen Trevett, CEO	Henrik Jorgensen	Robert Russo
1.9 Director(s)	Klaus-Michael Kuehne, Dr. Joerg Wolfe, Karl Gernandt + 5 others	Rodolphe Saade, Mathieu Friedberg, Michel Sirat	Ivana Schlumpberger (CFO), Bethany Solow (Marketing/HR), Michal Svoboda (COO), Harmony Lange (Trade Compliance), Jordan Perri (Tax)*	Tina Okragly, Shelly Hess, Paul-Henri Freret	Jeff Ramella — Director, Business Development
1.10 Global Employees	KN IL: 800 employees (KN Group: 74,000+)	78,000	400	14,000	0 (not disclosed)
1.11 US+CA Employees	~60 US+CA; ~53 Bogota CO; Operational: ~50	11,000; Operational: not specified	202; Operational: 130	44 (US only); Operational: 39	10; Operational: 10
1.12 Latin America	Mexico, Colombia, Brazil, Argentina (+ virtual coverage across LATAM)	Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Guatemala, Panama, Peru	Mexico, Argentina	Mexico, Brazil, Argentina, Chile	N/A
1.13 Intl ops for NA	Yes — 8 Control Tower locations across NA, LATAM, EMEA, APAC	Yes — 160+ countries	Yes — Canada, Mexico, Czech Republic, France, UK, Hungary, Dubai, India, China, Taiwan, Korea, Singapore, HK, Russia, Australia, NZ, Indonesia	Yes — Mexico, Argentina, Brazil, Chile	No
2. FINANCIAL DATA	KN	Ceva	Allyn	Gefco	Continental Logistics
2.1 Turnover US+CA	Not available (not broken out by region)	N/A (not broken out by region)	\$20-25M (2018), \$22-27M (2019), \$22-27M (2020F)	\$19.5M (2018), \$20M (2019), \$25M (2020F)	Not disclosed
2.1 Turnover Global	CHF 20.8B (2018), CHF 21.1B (2019) — KN Group	\$7.356B (2018), \$7.124B (2019), N/A (2020F)	\$35-40M (2018), \$40-45M (2019), \$40-45M (2020F)	EUR 4B (2018), EUR 4.2B (2019), EUR 4.5B (2020F)	Not disclosed
2.2 Profit/Loss	CHF 772M (2018), CHF 800M (2019) — KN Group; profitable	-\$242M (2018), -\$166M (2019), N/A (2020F)	\$4-7M USD (2018/2019/2020F)	\$150K (2018), \$78K (2019), \$100K (2020F) — US only	Not disclosed
2.3 Labor % of cost	Not disclosed (corporate policy)	Not disclosed	60-75%	16%	Not disclosed
2.4 Overhead % of cost	Not disclosed (corporate policy)	Not disclosed	25-40%	5%	Not disclosed
2.5 US Investment 2020	Not disclosed (corporate policy)	Not disclosed	\$0-5M USD	1%	Not disclosed
2.6 D&B; Number	118536775	80-692-2014	79-748-2239	79-098-2826	11-888-2752
2.7 MTS Specialist?	Yes — % not disclosed (corporate policy)	Yes — ~13.6% of revenue	Yes — 80-90% of revenue	No	Yes — ~80% of revenue*
3. MARKET DATA & INDUSTRY					

3.1 Industries Served	Consumer/Cosmetics, Pharmaceuticals/Med Devices, Chemical/Industrial, High Tech, Aerospace, Automotive — % not disclosed	Consumer & Retail 27%, Industrial & Aerospace 25%, Automotive 23%, Technology 17%, Healthcare 5%, Other 3%	Oil & Gas 25%, Electronics 30%, Aerospace/Defense 15%, Healthcare 5%, Other 25%	Pharmaceuticals 30%, Retail 20%, Automotive 18%, Industrial 10%, Aerospace 5%, Other 17%	Food, CPG
3.2 Expansion Plans?	Yes — organic growth; specific plan confidential	No	Yes	No (not in 2021)	Yes
3.2.1 Expansion Detail	Organic + selective M&A; details confidential	—	5% annual expansion	Not in 2021	—
3.3 NA Competitors	Not disclosed (corporate policy)	Kuehne and Nagel, XPO, DB Schenker, Expeditors, DSV	UPS 4PL, XPO Supply Chain, DHL 4PL	JAS Forwarding, DSV, Kuehne and Nagel, DHL, Bollore	Other transportation brokerages
3.4 MTS Customer Count	~50	>50	30	0	~200
3.5 US+CA Operations?	Yes	USA — Yes; Canada — Yes	Yes	No	USA mostly
3.6 Main Customers	Confidential (Consumer/Cosmetics vertical among 4 clients)*	Walmart, Honda Motors, General Motors, Rolls Royce (Aerospace), Primark	Confidential (Fortune 100 corporations; US, Canada, Europe, China, Australia, Mexico, India)*	Asmodee (MN), Automann (NJ), Monet Global (FL), Rhodes Pharmaceutical (NJ), BorgWarner (MI)	Not disclosed

4. TECHNICAL & QUALITY DATA	KN	Ceva	Allyn	Gefco	Continental Logistics
4.1 Certificates	ISO 9001:2015, ISO 14001:2015, ISO 22-301:2018, ISO 45001:2018 (Bureau Veritas); C-TPAT, PIP, TAPA, GxP, AEO, EN9100, Cargo IQ, BASC	ISO 9001:2015 (Global, Dec 2018, DEKRA Certification GmbH)	ISO 9001-compliant QMS (certification in progress)	C-TPAT (Forwarding USA, annual, Homeland Security)	None listed
4.2 Quality System?	Yes — ISO 9001 QSHE system; Bureau Veritas certified*	Yes — ISO 9001:2015 global QMS*	Yes — QMS ISO 9001 compliant	Qualio	Not specified
4.3 Parcel/LTL Partners?	Yes — 1,000+ LSPs globally; \$1.3B managed spend	Yes — multiple parcel carriers (location-dependent)	Yes — 25+ options (available under NDA)	Yes — FedEx, all LTL carriers, Forward Air, Panther	Yes — ABF, Estes, Saia, YRC, Old Dominion + others
4.4 Carrier Contracts?	Yes; mandatory: No (flexible contracting models)	Not answered	Yes (sourced under client contract); mandatory: No	Not answered; mandatory: No	Yes; mandatory: No
4.5 TMS?	Yes — Oracle OTM 6.4.1 + ControLOG (proprietary) + Tableau; mandatory: Yes (where appropriate)	Yes — CEVA Matrix TMS; mandatory: No	Yes — Allyn Logistics Application (proprietary); mandatory: No	Yes — Cargowise One; mandatory: Yes	Yes — Mercury Gate (migrating to 3PL Systems); mandatory: No
4.6 SLA (time zones)	Follow-the-sun model; regional ops centers; client-tailored coverage	No standard SLAs — negotiated individually per customer	Standard business hours 08:00-17:00; weekend/24-7 options available	5 regional US offices covering all time zones	Based on standard LTL transit times / legal HOS for TL
4.7 Escalation Process?	Yes — CAR/PAR/CST processes; dedicated account team*	Yes — Ops Supervisor > Ops Manager > Senior Exec Sponsor > EVP*	Yes	Yes — written escalation point per office/service	Yes
4.7 KPI Tool?	Tableau dashboards + Business Objects; 7+ standard reports + custom; on-time, cost, non-conformity, damage, carrier KPIs*	On-time service, claims, invoicing accuracy; additional metrics negotiable*	30+ KPIs: on-time delivery, cost savings, contract vs. spot, carrier performance*	Timely billing (air/ocean/customs), on-time delivery/shipment	TMS KPIs: on-time pickup/delivery, invoice turnover
4.8 Seasonality Handling	Predictive evaluation via historical patterns; flexible staffing; carrier alternatives*	Core FT + temp labor flex; borrowing from other CEVA sites; multi-shift options*	Staff and strategically source in advance	Customer service center in Chicago assists all US regions	Data trends + customer forecasts; food vertical experience*
4.9 Customs Expertise?	Yes — KN acts as broker/freight forwarder; trade consulting (HTS, FTZ, licenses)*	Yes — in-house customs brokerage in 50+ countries; full clearance suite*	Yes — US Licensed Customs Brokers on staff; trade compliance services	Yes — national customs clearance license for all US ports/airports	Carriers handle cross-border; not in-house customs brokerage
4.10 Freight Audit?	Yes — third-party partner for NA; hybrid in-house/3P in EU and APAC	Yes — partner not specified	Yes — multiple FPCs (freight payment companies)	No	Yes — done internally

5. RISK & CONTINUITY					
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5.1 BCP	Formal BCP: Risk Mgmt + Emergency Response + Continuity Guarantee; covers all LSPs*	Disaster Recovery Plan with power redundancy, off-site backups, SOPs per site*	Company T&Cs; apply (available on request)	Corporate backup in Amsterdam and Paris; cloud-based TMS	Full work-from-home capability; web-based systems
5.2 Outsourced Ops?	Minimal — freight audit outsourced in NA; rest is KN IL employees	Yes — direct presence in 60 countries; agents in 100	No — all in-house	No — all in-house	All in-house

Criterion-by-Criterion Scores (raw 0-100 per criterion, ranked order)

1. Strategic Fit (Industry) (15%)	88	72	42	30	38
2. Service Specialization (MTS) (15%)	82	55	70	5	50
3. Quality & ESG Certifications (15%)	95	62	45	25	10
4. Geographic Coverage (10%)	90	88	68	40	18
5. Financial Stability (10%)	85	38	60	55	15
6. Technology (TMS, KPIs) (10%)	92	60	65	55	35
7. Scale & Capacity (5%)	75	80	52	28	10
8. Carrier Network Flexibility (5%)	85	60	65	62	55
9. Operational Excellence (5%)	88	68	60	35	38
10. Risk Management & Continuity (5%)	88	72	45	42	30
11. RFI Response Quality (5%)	78	58	62	55	28

4. Per-Vendor Notes — Full Text of Summarized Answers (*)

The following entries were summarized to <=25 words in the comparison table (marked *). Full original text is reproduced below for due-diligence purposes.

4.1 KN

Field: 1.1 Company — Introduction

Kuehne + Nagel Integrated Logistics (KN IL) is the 4PL Managed Services division of Kuehne + Nagel Inc. It offers end-to-end supply chain management solutions with logistics control and integration across multiple regions, providers and modes using standardized business processes and systems, building on 20+ years of experience.

Field: 3.6 Main Customers

Due to confidentiality agreements, KN IL is unable to provide specific client names at this stage. As part of this RFI, case study examples are provided. KN IL serves the Consumer/Cosmetics vertical with 4 customers of similar geographic and business scope to L'Occitane. References will be honored at a later stage of the selection process.

Field: 4.2 Quality System

Kuehne + Nagel employs a QSHE (Quality, Safety, Health, Security, Environment) system certified to ISO 9001 by Bureau VERITAS. Work instructions across the customer base are created based on ISO 9001 standards plus customer-specific requirements. All KN employees and subcontractors use this system.

Field: 4.7 Escalation Process

Three escalation processes: (1) Corrective Action Process (CAR) — reporting, analysis and immediate resolution of non-conformities involving customers, employees, suppliers and service providers; (2) Preventive Action Program (PAR) — disciplined tracking of preventive actions; (3) Customer Service Tool (CST) — web-based tool within ControLOG to submit, view, edit and track issues across orders, shipments and non-transactional activities.

Field: 4.7 KPI Tool

Standard reports (daily/weekly/monthly/quarterly): On-time Pick-up, On-time Delivery, Volume & Cost Report, Non-Conformity Performance, Damage/Loss Reports, KPI Summary, Carrier KPI Report. Customized reports configurable per customer. Executive Dashboards in Tableau with drill-down by LSP/product/market in real-time. Auto-distributed on schedule or on-demand.

Field: 4.8 Seasonality Handling

Predictive evaluation using historical shipping patterns to harmonize visibility and anticipate demand swings. Historical carrier performance leveraged to identify alternative reliable partners. Flexible staffing balances core and shared resources; staffing models range from low-core (high-seasonality) to steady-state based on client profile.

Field: 4.9 Customs Expertise

KN acts as broker and freight forwarder, handling documentation, customs clearance and duty payments. KN IL coordinates all international shipment activities: managing freight forwarders and customs brokers, monitoring supplier shipping/docs, border clearance, documentation compliance. Trade Consulting: HTS audits/coding, license determination, FTZ development.

Field: 5.1 BCP

KN BCP/DR plan has three components: (1) Risk Management and Disaster Prevention — assessment of possible risks, preventive actions; (2) Effective Emergency Response Actions — procedures for disasters/emergencies/serious incidents; (3) Guarantee Continuity of Operations — emergency processes ensuring continuous client support, infrastructure requirements, communication plan covering clients and all LSPs in use.

4.2 Ceva

Field: 4.2 Quality System

CEVA, world-wide, has a Quality Management System certified to ISO 9001:2015. It applies to key processes controlling services, controls daily activities to ensure customer needs are met, ensures all employees including upper management are engaged in quality, and is designed to apply to all services throughout the world.

Field: 4.7 Escalation Process

Escalation path: Operations Supervisor/Lead → Operations Manager → Senior Executive Sponsor → CEVA Executive Vice President. Contact names and phone numbers are provided with a defined escalation plan tailored to client needs.

Field: 4.7 KPI Tool

Internal metrics: on-time service performance, claims, unannounced operational/security audit performance, quality audit results, CAR responsiveness. Customer-facing metrics: on-time service, claims, timely invoicing, accurate invoicing. Additional client-specific factors also measured.

Field: 4.8 Seasonality Handling

Full-time associates cover stable/minimum volumes; temporary personnel handle volatile fluctuations scheduled under 40 hrs/week. Additional resources drawn from other CEVA locations. Second/third shifts and 10-hr days added for extended surges. Corporate support staff, SMEs and logistics engineering resources available. Clients provide Black Friday/peak forecasts; ramp-up schedule agreed; additional MHE rented during peak.

Field: 4.9 Customs Expertise

CEVA has in-house customs brokerage in 50+ countries. Services include: Customs Entry Preparation and Electronic Filing, HTS Classification Support, Importer Security Filing, Liquidation Monitoring, Post Entry/PSC Preparation, Reconciliation Filing, FTZ Entry Processing, Customized Reporting, Web-based customs tracking tool.

Field: 5.1 BCP

CEVA Disaster Recovery Plan: notification roster in escalation format, natural disaster procedures (fire/tornado: escape routes, muster, rescue), power outage procedures (UPS/generator for critical systems), system failure procedures (RF, server, comms, PC, printer, software). Each contracted operation maintains a Potential Problem Analysis (PPA) with responsibility assignments, vendor contacts, and likely problem scenarios. Onsite redundancy: Culpepper (USCD) + Ashburn (USAD) Data Centers, real-time automated recovery, daily automated backups, off-site tape vaults.

4.3 Allyn

Field: 1.9 Director(s)
Ivana Schlumberger, CFO; Bethany Solow, Marketing and HR Director; Michal Svoboda, COO; Harmony Lange, Global Trade Compliance Director; Jordan Perri, Tax Director.

Field: 3.6 Main Customers
Client Confidential — can be provided in a presentation. Fortune 100 Corporations are in our client list. Countries: US, Canada, Europe, China, Australia, Mexico, India.

Field: 4.7 KPI Tool
On-Time Delivery, Cost Savings, Contract vs. Spot Quote, Shipment planning and tracking, Carrier Performance & more. Over 30 KPIs (see KPI sheet attached separately).

4.4 Gefco
No summarized answers — all table entries are full verbatim text.

4.5 Continental Logistics

Field: 2.7 MTS Specialist — revenue %
Answer cell value: '0.8' (interpreted as 80%). The vendor did not explicitly write '80%'; the cell contained the decimal 0.8.

Field: 4.8 Seasonality Handling
Being in the food vertical seasonality is something that we are extremely familiar with, we use data trends and customer forecasts to stay in control of seasonality demands.